

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, this was what I was most excited to test. The Redmi 12 5G is the first smartphone in India that is powered by Qualcomm's latest budget chipset, the Snapdragon 4 Gen 2. Now, since this is the first smartphone with the new entry-level chip, I was naturally excited to test the Redmi 12 5G's performance. The Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 chip is paired with up to 8GB of RAM, which is expandable to up to 16GB using Xiaomi's virtual RAM expansion technology.

Now, given the newer chip, we see a jump in performance numbers as compared to the Snapdragon 4 Gen 1, which was last seen on the Redmi 12 5G's more premium cousin, the Redmi Note 12 5G. In benchmarks, the Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 showed a good 20-25 percent increase in the performance numbers over the previous generation chipset (which we last tested on the Redmi Note 12 5G). For example, on AnTuTu, the Redmi 12 5G put out a score of 452431 points, which is 24 percent higher than the Redmi Note 12 5G's score of 363836 points.

On Geekbench, the performance jump is much more significant. In the single-core test, the Snapdragon 4 Gen 2-powered Redmi 12 5G showed an over 51 percent jump in performance, putting out a score of 923 points. In multi-core tests, the Redmi 12 5G showed an 18 percent jump in performance, putting out a score of 2183 points. In the next CPU-based benchmark, PCMark Work 3.0, however, the results were opposite. The Redmi 12 5G showed a decline in the numbers as compared to the Redmi Note 12 5G, which runs on the Snapdragon 4 Gen 1 chip. Surprising.

The GPU performance of the Redmi 12 5G was disappointing. The smartphone only put out a score of only 665 in 3D Mark Wild Life test, and wasn't able to pull as many frames as some of the other competing devices in this segment in the GFXBench test. Now, while this is not up to the mark and will disappoint those who will game on this smartphone, it is still a step up, since this time around, a Redmi



smartphone ran all the GPU benchmarks we threw its way. Furthermore, when I played games on the Redmi 12 5G, I didn't feel any kind of a lack in performance of frame rates. Plus, the smartphone didn't heat up much and there were no frame drops even during longer gaming sessions, so the optimisation here is very good, even if the numbers are underwhelming.

BATTERY

Coming to battery, this again is an impressive aspect of the smartphone. The Redmi 12 5G offers a 5,000mAh battery unit, which will easily give you up to two days if you are a casual or light user! This is great for people who will only charge their smartphones at home or at their office. In my tests, the Redmi 12 5G came through with impressive results. Playing Call of Duty Mobile on the highest-possible settings for 15 minutes only drained 3 percent of the smartphone's battery. So did watching an HD video on YouTube for 30 minutes straight. Further, I also used the GPS for 1 straight hour, and here also the results were good as the smartphone lost 9 percent of the battery. It is important to note that the Redmi 12 5G heated up a bit while navigating using GPS.

The charging, however, is slow by today's standards. Now, this smartphone supports 18W fast charging and it took almost two hours (1 hour 56 minutes) or 116 minutes for the Redmi 12 5G to charge from 0 to 100 percent. So yes, if you want to charge it in one go, you need to have some patience.

CAMERA

Camera on the Redmi 12 5G is a dual rear camera setup where we get a primary 50-megapixel shooter and a 2-megapixel depth sensor. The camera performance from the primary shooter is pretty good. The images aren't the most sharp, but the dynamic range and detail from this are brilliant.

In portraits, the Redmi 12 5G struggles a bit with edge detection, which seems too aggressive, but the depth sensor steps in here to provide a nice depth-of-field to images. Good stuff. In low lights, the camera again struggles to take sharp images, but the results are workable most of the time.

VERDICT

So overall, after going through rigorous testing and usage, the Redmi 12 5G feels worth the price. In fact, for a smartphone that starts at under ₹11,000, this is a superb deal! We get a nice and premium design with a huge display, we get a fairly powerful and very efficient chip, and a long-lasting battery backup. Yes, the charging is slow and the camera misses here and there, but at just ₹10,999, I'm not complaining at all!

The smartphone aims to make 5G more accessible to all smartphone users in the country and that, it does with great style and poise. This, after quite some time, feels like Xiaomi doing what the brand does best, making new technology more accessible to facilitate mass adaptation. So yes, if you are in the market for an entry-level 5G smartphone, the Redmi 12 5G is probably the best option under a ₹12,000 budget.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon® 4 Gen 2 Mobile Platform | Storage: 256 GB | RAM: 8 GB | Display: 6.79" FHD+ Display | Refresh rate: 90 Hz | Cameras (rear): 50 MP + 2 MP depth | Selfie camera: 8 MP | Speaker: Mono, Bottom Firing | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 22.5 W wired

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